

Pastor's Report: April 2024

April activity

Worship

- Sundays
- on vacation April 7

Ministry of Presence and Relationship

- regular communication with Pastor Fue and Kirangare Parish leaders
- one-on-ones with Zion people and guests in worship
- hospital and home communion visits
- pre-marriage visit

Formation/Training

- Confirmation - final class of the academic year
- Wednesday morning Bible study
- Wednesday evening group spiritual direction
- Pastor's continuing education: Living School, trimester 1 modules 11-13 and into "Integration Month"
- Pastor's reading: *Defending Democracy from Its Christian Enemies* by David P. Gushee

Admin and Planning

- sustainability
- listening campaign - listening to listeners and supporting effort
- new Church Management Software (CMS) planning: Breeze by June 30
- preparation for Colleen's medical leave May 30 for 6-8 weeks

Synod and Colleagues

- weekly Pastor's bible study
- Synod Dean's meeting in person

Purpose

Listening

Like the last listening campaign, this one launched on Easter Sunday and continuing into mid-May will:

- connect 1-1 with all 150+ Zion people, both members and active non-members
- build relationships of ongoing care and concern
- foster a greater sense of belonging and investment
- create clarity for mission

- develop and identify leaders

It's about strengthening Zion from the foundation--relationships. It will conclude 5/16 with a debrief meeting. We'll celebrated and hear an initial report of what the team heard on Sunday, 5/19.

Break In

On Thursday 4/25, a young man who visited Zion's pantry and the meal site remained in the building. Churches United had no one at the front door that night. After Zion's activities concluded around 8pm, he came out of hiding and tripped the alarm motion sensors. Colleen got a call from the alarm company, and instead of dispatching police, she called the Zion people who had just left. They returned to the building around 8:30pm and without knowing it, chased away the intruder. They found sanctuary lights on but otherwise noticed nothing else. Around 11pm, he returned, broke a window on the Sacristy outer door and gained entry to the building. Again he tripped the alarm, and the alarm company dispatched police immediately. Before police arrived, the young man fled. Police found the main office broken into and many items stolen. Steve Keller came to the building and walked through with police. They all left around 1am 4/26. Around 5am, the young man returned, triggered the alarm, police responded. They found my office broken into and additional items stolen.

The next day around noon, police arrested a young man who had in his possession a Zion credit card, keys, and a personal check from my office. He later confessed. Police recovered the DVR and monitor for our video surveillance system, many files including financial documents, church keys, and the livestream camera. Stolen and unrecovered items include:

- 9 Ensemble microphones
- 1 Pre-Amp
- 2 Wireless over-ear microphones for Pastor and Assistant
- Outside and inside door keys
- Pastor Janine's laptop
- Pastor Clark's laptop (previously the livestream laptop)

Colleen is working with Church Mutual, our insurance company, to submit claims. We've employed Satin Glass to replace broken windows in the Sacristy and my office doors, and J&J Locksmiths to change external and internal door locks. The Ensemble mics and pre-amp have been replaced. David Hansen is working to replace the

wireless over-ear microphones. We haven't replaced the laptops yet. And the main office door has not yet been secured. It will have to be temporarily secured while we await a new custom door. Colleen and I also met with Global Security, our security company; our system functioned as intended.

We also took steps to facilitate healing in worship, including "rebaptizing" the violated spaces and writing notes to the young man who broke in and stole from Zion.

We're working on new processes and policies to close the vulnerabilities this exposed, including reducing the number of different keys Zion needs, relocating and securing high value storage, and asking Churches United

to have two paid staff members at every meal site, one of whom stays at the main door as long as guests are in the building.

May plans

All the normal stuff, plus:

- Youth Service & Fun Day - 9 youth plus adults, a good start!
- listening campaign - debrief campaign, communicate with congregation, and prepare for action
- Living School, trimester 2 Online gathering, modules 14

[council](#)